

The Glorious Revolution Of 1688 in England

Zayed AlHaleeshi

Abstract

This article is an examination of the Glorious Revolution of England in 1688, which was an event that changed Britain's English Civil War and changed England forever. This article will look at the events that led to the political and religious conflict during the revolution. Key figures such as William of Orange and James II played important roles in the revolution, which also involved significant military and political movements. The aftermath saw significant constitutional changes that aimed at strengthening the parliament's power, a change in political authority towards the promotion of Christianity in England, and economic reforms that promoted England's financial growth and set the stage for further development.

Keywords: Revolution, English Civil War, Political movement, Economic Reform, Parliamentary Power.

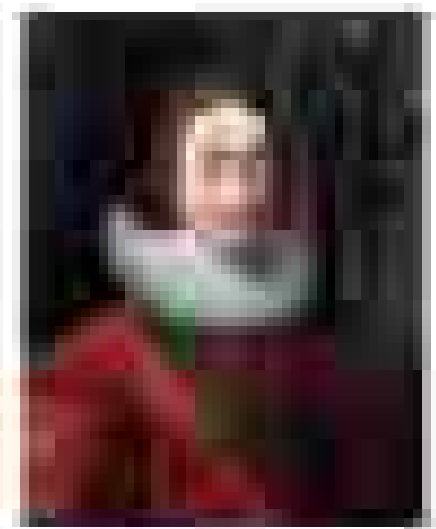
#constitutional changes

Introduction

The Glorious Revolution was a major turning point in English history, which changed the balance of power between the monarchy and the Parliament. The causes of the revolution go back to the conflicts over religious and political control during the English Civil War. The research will examine the causes of the revolution, major events that led to the revolution, and the aftermath of the revolution. The research will also focus on key figures such as James II and William of Orange. The purpose of this research is to explore how the revolution helped create a nation that supported economic growth and protected individual rights. "The English Glorious Revolution of 1688-89 is one of the most famous episodes of nineteenth century world history. It has fascinated scholars because of the role it may have played in creating nineteenth century production by making England the first industrial nation." (Peters and Halstead). We will also examine how the revolution acted as religious reforms, the role of the Parliament, as well as promoting checks and balances to the government. Lastly, the research will examine the economic changes that helped England become a powerful nation and a dominant force worldwide.

English Civil War

The English Civil War, which took place in 1642-1651, was an important conflict that not only weakened the political power of England but also set the stage for the English Revolution. It was a civil war between the supporters of King Charles I, who was known as a Royalist or Cavalier, and those who supported the Long Parliament, who were called Roundheads. This war was caused due to the issues between religious persecution, religious freedom, and royal authority, which led to the fight for power in England. One of the main



reason of the civil war was due to religious issues. Firstly, the political tensions between King Charles I and the parliament became bad in the 1640's. Charles tried to govern without parliament and his ideas on imposing laws without consent were unpopular. Roundheads were the members of the Puritans, Presbyterians and Calvinists who played an important role, but the King favoured the Anglicans. He ignored the other groups who wanted reforms in the Church of England (Catholics). Religious tensions were also a factor in the war. Puritans believed that bishops without the approval of the Parliament should be removed along with other church officials, such as tithing parsons and bishops, who had been removed by the King's decision. The first result of the Civil War was that the Parliamentarians gained significant victories after the Battle of Marston and captured important land. The second result was Charles's defeat in his attempt to regain power with the support of Ireland, and he was forced to flee. The third civil war resulted in Charles's son, Charles II's escape with the Puritans against the Commonwealth which was established by Oliver Cromwell, a military commander during the First Civil War, however, they were defeated in the Battle of Worcester which ended the Royalists hopes of restoring their power. After this series of civil wars, the English government was changed.

When Charles the First was executed in 1649, there was still no political power where the divine right of kings was challenged and established the parliamentary supremacy, in which the parliament were in the control. However, republicanism was not the final solution of the Commonwealth with the help of Cromwell, constitutional rule was developed and religious dictatorship was proved, however, these events stopped a power vacuum for the country needed a king to rule over England. So Charles II proclaimed his Declaration of Breda in April 1660, which proposed a pardon for all the crimes he committed during the Civil War, he returned to the throne as a king and the 11 years of his reign was a temporary which was known as the Restoration from 1660 and 1702 he ended. And by 20 May, Charles II was officially a king. The war was a failure in England in which the constitution was still unchanged, which proved that even for a revolution.

Causes of the Revolution:

After the English civil war had ended, the Glorious Revolution was going to take place, but what were the causes of the Glorious Revolution? One of the primary causes of the Revolution was the religious conflict between the Catholics and Protestants in England. James II was a Catholic and always implemented policies that were aligned with Catholics. However, the Protestant population were dissatisfied with these policies, and his attempt to promote religious tolerance through the Declaration of Indulgence in 1687 was not supported at all, even the government were against his Catholicism and his reign in England. When James's son was born in June of the year 1688, Protestant Method to many said again in that time as that that a Catholic, therefore, many people and nobles and they were looking for an alternative if there was a protestant dynasty. James II also continued political involvement during his reign, his style of ruling was similar to his father's, which ultimately caused the civil war, and James's dismissal of many important officials who were against his policies started decreasing his support along with parliament.

James. Lastly, the arrest of the Seven Bishops for going against his Declaration of Indulgence went mostly unopposed, but gained public support against James. However, James' original focus of the Revolution was the abolition of William of Orange, due to James' Catholicism, a group of seven influential nobles called the "Immortal Seven" advised William of Orange to invade England. The intention was to force a change in the English throne by overthrowing James and to eliminate a potential alliance between a Catholic England and France. William's army was proclaimed officially landed in November 1688 and the event was more dramatically to cause a revolution in Protestant rule in England.

The Glorious Revolution

On November 6, 1688, William of Orange landed at the city of Brixham with his army in the south of England. His was called the first day of the "Protestant Wind" which allowed William's troops to sail readily from the Netherlands to England and at the same time, gave James's fleet a very hard time to prepare and sail. On August 11, 1688, his army had reached 11,000 troops made up of experienced fighters who were Dutch, English, Scots etc. which outnumbered James II, and his fleet had arrived with ships, it was both larger and larger than when the English had encountered during the Spanish Armada (Harris, 2022). When he landed in Brixham, William informed the English that he and queen "I came to do you good, I am here for all your good" (Harris, 118). William's rapid arrival changed the political landscape, as many Protestant officers that were in James's army decided to defect and join with William's army instead, including important officers such as John Churchill, who became the Duke of Marlborough.

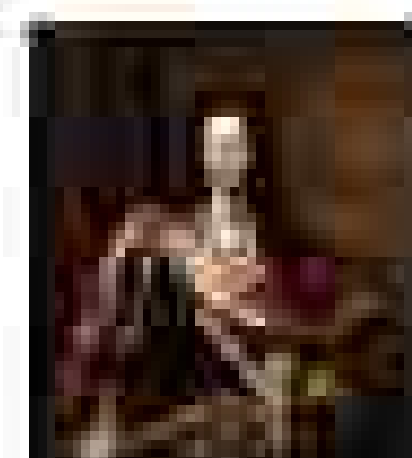
The James started to pick up support from many locations, which included influential nobles and political elites who were disappointed with James's Catholic policies as well. This reaction deflected the fight in the dwindling support for James II. As William's army's strength increased as well as his forces, his resistance for resistance was overthrown, and on December 23, James escaped to France leaving William victorious as he and his wife Mary II reformed the English throne. The success was undoubtedly in the throne due to the strong support of James II and the successful rebellion of his army, and with little to no resistance, James had no other choice but to flee England.



William of Orange landing in Brixham, 1688. (The National Archives)

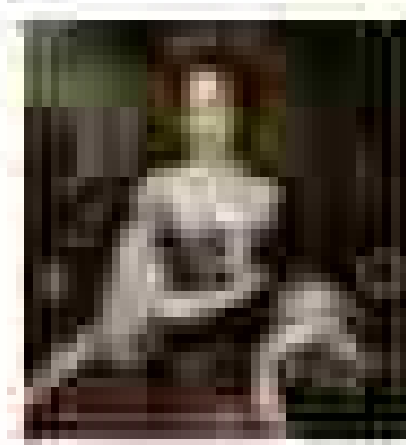
Important Figures of the Revolution

William III. One of the most important figures during the Glorious Revolution was William III or William of Orange. He was the central figure of the revolution as he was invited by the Immortal Seven, who were a group of seven distinguished English nobles who wanted to overthrow James II's Catholic rule. He was born in the 16th of November 1650 as a Dutchman by birth. He was also James's nephew and son-in-law as he married James's Protestant daughter Mary II. Due to his strategic planning and his military leadership as he received the greatest lot of support from many nobles who were disappointed with James's reign. And as he landed in London, James was forced to flee making William a successful monarch (Harris, 2022).



William III, King of England and France, 1689-1702. (The National Archives)

Mary II (Mary II, born on April 16, 1662, is the daughter of James II and was married to William III, the glancing significance during the revolution as the Marriage of William was a symbol of union between English Protestants and the Dutch who were both against a Catholicism. She was raised in a Protestant household and was educated in the principles of Protestantism, which shaped her political beliefs.



However, her father converted to Catholicism and attempted to impose Catholic policies which was one of the main points of the revolution. And as William was united by the natural love to which England, she felt that she should support her husband and stand beside him. When William successfully took over London, he and Mary were crowned the second joint monarchs. She represented the hope for Protestant England (BBC History, 2017).

James II (James II) was the reigning monarch whose policies and actions caused the Glorious Revolution. His attempts to promote religious tolerance using his Declaration of Indulgence alienated the Protestants, and when he was born in June 1688, Mary feared that a Catholic dynasty would emerge. These events along with many others caused the revolution as William was united to marry England to an enemy in Scotland, James, which was successful and James was forced to flee England.

The Aftermath

The Glorious Revolution brought major changes to England's Constitution, politics, and religious policies, which helped in developing the state of England. The Declaration of Rights in October 1689, which was named the Bill of Rights, listed the powers of the monarch, it stated that the Crown didn't own military Parliament's consent, regular parliamentary sessions, free elections as well and the freedom of speech in the parliament was also implemented. More importantly, the Bill of Rights also affirmed the succession of James II, which established the principle that the monarch was also subject to the law.

The Toleration Act of 1689 was enacted to protect various sects as Puritans, Presbyterians, Methodists, Unitarians and Jews among others, which helped to affirm a tolerant society from being established, which was a significant landmark in religious tolerance history. The Glorious Revolution caused a change in the relation of power towards the Parliament, which led to the emergence of modern party politics. The Whig Party (pro) with manufacturing and long-distance trading sectors, which allowed them to gain prominence.

This also caused the abolition of various rules and people, which challenged the royal monopoly of direct rights. William III's desire to work with the Parliament allowed them to reduce his dependence and give up a national system system, which further solidified the shift in power. Lastly, the revolution had major consequences in the economic sector. Parliament was responsible for the national debt, thus reducing the government's financial stability and allowing long-term borrowing.

To service these debts (over 100), Parliament committed various measures and introduced new taxes, which led to the establishment of the Bank of England in 1694 and the rise of the London stock market, which strengthened England's power recovery. Increased security of property rights encouraged domestic investment and trade reforms helped in the shape of Hume's economic liberalism.

Conclusion

In conclusion, The Glorious Revolution was an important historical event in English History that it played a huge role in changing the politics, economy and the Constitution. Inspired by a number of factors such as religious freedom, political authoritarianism by James II, as well as the influence of William of Orange, the revolution resulted in a successful transition of power which confirmed parliamentary rule and removed Catholicism. William of Orange's descent in England was caused by religious discrimination with James II's rule, as well as his new policies, which quickly led to the creation of a constitutional monarchy with the rise of William and Mary II.

This marked the start of an era in which royal power was restricted by the authority of the Parliament. William, Mary II and the Seven Bishops were the key figures in the revolution as they helped in ending the struggle to bring the monarch to their knees, with James II's own abandonment his subjects. After the revolution had ended, major constitutional changes took place, as the Bill of Rights was passed down which helped in securing Parliament's role. In the economic sector, a period of rapid growth took place, where the Bank of England was established and the London stock market rose, which helped in Britain's future economic success.

Thanks to the Glorious Revolution, a sophisticated more democratic constitution was established in England, in which the government protected the rights of the English citizens and the role of the Monarchy shifted the focus of English society and establishing a more political system, as well as creating constitutional monarchy as the primary instrument of power.